

SELECT COALESCE (favorite_color,
backup_color, 'blue') AS color
FROM friends;

This means:

→ If favorite_colour is missing (NULL)
then check backup_color.

→ If backup_color is also missing, then
use 'blue'.

→ It gives first 'real' answer it finds.

"Find the first toy that's not an
empty box"

Customers	cust_name	phone_num	W/A
101	John	071111 1111	NULL
102	Mary	NULL	0822222222
103	Peter	NULL	NULL
104	Abdunigo	0712345678	0854321000

Write an SQL query to give me the
name of the customer & their contact
details

SELECT cust_name,
COALESCE (phone_number, W-A, 0000)
AS contact_number
FROM customers;



cust_name	contact_number
John	071111 1111
Mary	082222 2222
Peter	0000
Abdunigo	071234 5678

Sequence is important. It decides
which backup gets chosen first.

ISNULL

Think of it like asking: "Is this box empty?"

→ If the box has no toy inside (NULL),

then ISNULL says TRUE (Yes, it's empty).

→ If the box has a toy (any value), then

ISNULL says FALSE (No, it's not empty)

↳ A way to check if there is a null value
in a specific column

↳ Can use it in our WHERE statement